

Charadrius melodus

Piping Plover

Family (Charadriidae)

Kingdom (Animalia)

Status (Endangered and Threatened)

Description

Size: 18 cm in length. Color: Breeding season: Pale brown above, lighter below; black band across forehead; bill orange with black tip; legs orange; white rump. Male: Complete or incomplete black band encircles the body at the breast. Female: Paler head band; incomplete breast band. Winter coloration: Bill black; all birds lack breast band and head band.



Location/Habitat

The species historical range included Alabama, Colorado, Connecticut, Delaware, Florida, Georgia, Illinois, Indiana, Iowa, Kansas, Kentucky, Louisiana, Maine, Maryland, Massachusetts, Michigan, Minnesota, Mississippi, Missouri, Montana, Nebraska, New Hampshire, New Jersey, New York, North Carolina, North Dakota, Ohio, Oklahoma, Pennsylvania, Puerto Rico, Rhode Island, South Carolina, South Dakota, Texas, Virginia, Virgin Islands, Wisconsin, Wyoming. See below for information about where the species is known or believed to occur.

Sources: <https://www.fws.gov/species/search>
<https://ecos.fws.gov/ecp/report/species-listings-by-state-totals?statusCategory=Listed>
<https://efotg.sc.egov.usda.gov/#/state/CR/documents/section=4&folder=-3>